

Lab Inventory Manager Tutorial

Welcome to the Lab Inventory Manager! This system is designed to streamline how we track materials, manage purchase requests, and analyze lab spending.

User Guide

The User Dashboard is the primary interface for day-to-day lab operations. You can access the cloud version here: <https://inventory-manager-vqn8frroox9sjqncawrjhg.streamlit.app/>

1. Inventory Dashboard

The first thing you see is the **Inventory Dashboard**. It provides a high-level overview of everything in the lab.

- **Metrics:** See “Total Unique Items” and “Low Stock Alerts” at a glance.
- **Search & Filter:** Use the **Quick Search** bar to find items by name, owner, or location. You can also filter by source (Purchased vs. Made in Lab).
- **Categorized Tabs:** Items are automatically sorted into tabs like Buffer, Chemical, Consumables, etc.
- **Low Stock Management:** At the bottom, look for the **Item Management** section.
 - **Quick Reorder:** Click this to immediately submit a request for an item that is running low.
 - **Dismiss/Archive:** Use this if an item is no longer needed in the lab.

2. Request a Purchase

Never order something twice! The system uses a two-step wizard:

- **Step 1: The Gatekeeper Search:** Search for the item first. The system will tell you if we already have it in stock, if someone else has already ordered it, or if it’s in our archived history.
 - If you see a match, you can click **“Order More of This Item”** to pre-fill the form.

- **Step 2: Request Details:** Fill out the requester name, specs (volume, purity, etc.), vendor, catalog number, and price.
 - **Keep on Ice:** Crucial! Check this if the item needs cold storage upon arrival.
 - **New Vendors:** If a vendor isn't in the list, select "Add New Vendor" to enter it.

3. Log Usage

To keep our inventory accurate, please log whenever you use a material.

1. Go to **Log Usage**.
2. Select the item from the dropdown (you will see the current stock).
3. Enter your name and the amount used.
4. **Note:** The system prevents you from logging more than what is currently in stock.

4. Metrics & History

Curious about lab spending or usage patterns?

- **Financial Overview:** View total spending and charts broken down by category and vendor.
 - **Activity Log:** See the "Most Frequently Used Items" and the "Recent Activity Log" to see what's been happening in the lab.
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